

GRANT LEYDA

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Portfolio: leydagrant-ux.github.io/PortfolioGrantLeyda

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Recent B.S. Mechanical Engineering graduate from the University of Arkansas (Aerospace Concentration, May 2026) with a 3.37 GPA and hands-on experience in SolidWorks CAD design, FEA structural analysis, and MATLAB. Proven ability to deliver complex engineering projects from concept through manufacturing, highlighted by a capstone senior design project involving a 2,000 lb industrial chassis rotator. SolidWorks CSWA certified. Strong communicator with a background in commission sales and customer service, recognized on the Chancellor's and Dean's List.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

CAD / Design: SolidWorks (CSWA Certified), Autodesk Inventor, CAD/3D Modeling, 3D Printing

Analysis: FEA (Finite Element Analysis), Von Mises Stress, Displacement & Factor of Safety Analysis, Fluid Flow Simulation (CFD), West Point Bridge Designer

Programming: MATLAB, Computer Methods for Engineering

Manufacturing: Parts Sourcing, Machining, Assembly, BOM Development, Exploded View Drawings

Soft Skills: Team Leadership, Communication, Time Management, Problem Solving, Client Relations

ENGINEERING PROJECTS

Senior Capstone: Cram-A-Lot Manufacturing Chassis Rotator

Fall 2025 – Spring 2026

University of Arkansas — Sponsored by JVM / Cram-A-Lot | Team Design & Build Project

- Designed and built an automated mechanism to rotate industrial chassis up to 2,000 lbs by 180°, accommodating four different chassis configurations within an 8 ft × 5 ft footprint
- Performed SolidWorks FEA on all critical structural components — Von Mises stress, displacement, and factor of safety — verifying a minimum factor of safety of 1.6 (1.6–3.6 across components) under the 2,000 lb max load at multiple rotation angles
- Led manufacturing phase including materials sourcing, machining at UA and JVM facilities, and full system assembly at sponsor's warehouse — delivered a functional, tested device
- Produced complete BOM (\$5,432 total cost), exploded view drawings, and full assembly documentation in SolidWorks
- Eliminated reliance on crane-based rotation process that was causing equipment damage and workflow inefficiency

Full-Stack Session Tracking & Analytics Web App (PWA)

2026

Personal Project | leydagrant-ux.github.io/Bankroll • github.com/leydagrant-ux/Bankroll

- Designed, built, and deployed a multi-user progressive web app (~2,200 lines) with Firebase Authentication and Cloud Firestore, live on GitHub Pages and installable on iOS
- Authored and published Firestore security rules enforcing per-user data isolation and invite-code-only group access, verified end-to-end against the live backend
- Built weekly and all-time leaderboards with an animated SVG visualization scaling continuously to performance, including reduced-motion accessibility support
- Implemented CSV import/export with backward-compatible schema migration so existing user data survives every release

MATLAB Engineering Computation

Spring 2024

- Applied computational methods to solve complex engineering problems including numerical analysis and simulation

SolidWorks CAD Certification

Fall 2023

- Completed a comprehensive CAD design course and earned the SolidWorks CSWA (Certified SolidWorks Associate) credential

Bridge Design Project

Spring 2023

- Used West Point Bridge Designer to engineer a bridge structure meeting specified load and constraint requirements

CAD / Autodesk Inventor

Fall 2021

- Completed a design and presentation course with hands-on 3D modeling using Autodesk Inventor

EDUCATION

University of Arkansas — Fayetteville, AR

Graduated May 2026

B.S. Mechanical Engineering | Aerospace Concentration | GPA: 3.37

- Chancellor's List & Dean's List — Spring 2023 (4.0 GPA)
- Member, Sigma Phi Epsilon — Arkansas Alpha Chapter

WORK EXPERIENCE

Olive Garden

Summer 2025

Waiter

- Served guests in a high-volume, fast-paced restaurant environment; coordinated with kitchen and front-of-house staff to keep service running on time

Sunder Energy

May 2024 – January 2025

Commission Sales Associate

- Managed full sales cycle for residential solar solutions, consistently meeting commission targets in a highly competitive environment
- Developed strong prospecting, objection handling, and closing skills through direct customer engagement

LGCY Power

April 2023 – January 2024

Commission Sales Associate

- Generated solar energy sales through door-to-door outreach; built rapport with customers to educate them on renewable energy products

Lushaj's Pasta & Pizza

June 2021 – Spring 2023

Waiter & Back Prep

- Delivered high-volume customer service in a fast-paced environment; coordinated front and back of house operations

Kroger

March 2020 – October 2020

Customer Service & Cashier

- Provided friendly, efficient service to customers; handled transactions and resolved service issues professionally